

I hit my Thirties Crisis the way a bowling ball hits the headpin. Suddenly I didn't sleep well and woke up feeling nauseated. Doctors took stomach X-rays but found nothing. During the day I had a vague sense of uneasiness. I worried about earthquakes in China and plane crashes in Honduras. I worried about being unable to pronounce the names of Arab leaders.

One night after a Peat Marwick training session I found myself having a drink with my mentor—the one who would soon sponsor me for partnership. I'll call this person Harriet. I think we were arguing a disputed play in the Super Bowl when I said, "I'm not doing so well."

"What's the problem?"

"Thirties Crisis."

"What kind of crisis is that?"

"You know. Your typical Thirties Crisis."

"What kind of crisis is that?" Good listener, Harriet.

"Whither are we wandering? What am I doing here? What's life all about? What's the meaning of our day-to-day existence?"

Harriet listened for a while longer, then nodded gravely and said, "You know, Paul, you never find the answers to those questions. But after a while the questions go away."

We had a good laugh. But Harriet was right, thank God. After a few months I was back to normal. Normal, that is, if a life of hard work can be called normal. But those tricky questions were buried. The "keep your head down" or "wait for the questions to go away" approach had passed its first test.

But eventually those questions came back, and I began searching for alternative approaches to life. One is "wait'll you die." The movie *Caddy Shack* has some funny lines about this approach.

In *Caddy Shack* comedian Bill Murray plays the demented greenskeeper Carl. Barely able to maintain himself, Carl lives on the fringes of adult struggle. He makes the Roman emperor Nero look stable. Carl talks to himself. For fun he